

Marine mammals

Whales and dolphins are not the only marine mammals. Sea otters and polar bears are mammals that spend an awful lot of their time in the water—but, unlike whales and dolphins, they can also walk about on land.



What's for dinner?

Sea otters hunt in kelp forests for a range of seafood. They love to eat sea urchins, but will also munch on crabs, fish, squid, and mussels.

Sailors have long called sea otters the “old men of the sea” because of their white whiskers and expressive faces.

Sea otters spend most of their time in the sea.

Fur, fur, and more fur

Sea otters have incredibly dense fur, which keeps them warm. In a patch of fur the size of your fingernail, there are about 100,000 hairs—that's the same as the number of hairs on a human head!

